

world, and indeed during Covid-19, the world has discovered that the skills that are required are going to be a lot more fluid and dynamic. There was a certain stasis to the skilling ecosystem—not just in India but around the world—which was, ‘we will have some job roles, we will skill people on the job roles, and then they will find jobs’. What is evident post-Covid-19 is that first, the workforce participation and the mix have gone through a major transformation—where women were not participating, they are participating; where women’s participation was low, it is going up; where men’s participation dominated, women’s participation is increasing. So, there is a lot of fluidity and dynamic changes in the skills that the workforce requires. Second, digital skilling has become like a prerequisite or an important component of all skills and traits. Third, skilling via digital platforms, and not the traditional classrooms or traditional workshops or traditional apprenticeships, has also become an important element.

Now, there is a fourth element to it—migration for work/employment has shown a reverse trend post-Covid-19. People want to go back and seek participation in the workforce locally as a first preference. [Our] Prime Minister said in July 2021

that we need to look at a new type of model... sort of a post-Covid-19 model. And that new model has three-four basic components to it. First, it is not only going to be about ab initio skilling. It is about skilling, reskilling, upskilling, and multiple skilling. So, a student who comes into the skilling ecosystem, doesn’t come on a one-time basis. If he is a school dropout, he doesn’t come in there to skill for a one-time job. But he enters this almost like a totally new education universe system, where he enters with ab initio skilling.

could have more interesting models of hybrid skilling, where you do some amount of physical [training], some digital [training]. Third, digital skills are now put out as part of almost all of the 4,000 courses and jobs that we are skilling. Going back to the issue of migration and people wanting opportunities closer to their homes and communities, we are creating district skilling plans for each of the 700 districts. The Government of India has appointed a Mahatma Gandhi National Fellow for each district,

community in the state and within the country. And the fourth element is Skill India International, which is for opportunities for people to go abroad.

And we’ve recently launched something in Dubai called Skill India International Tejas. So, this is the direction we are taking... And it is not one size fits all—each district will have its unique requirements for the youth of that district, for the aspirations of the district... We will use our network of Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY), ITIs [industrial training institutes], Jan Shikshan

IF A COMPANY WANTS TO REMAIN COMPETITIVE AND CONTINUE TO GROW, IT NEEDS TO INVEST TO MAKE SURE ITS TALENT IS UPSKILLED, RESKILLED, MULTIPLE SKILLED, CURRENTLY SKILLED, CONTEMPORARILY SKILLED

Then he can move left or adjacent to reskill, and move up the ladder with upskilling; he/she can also choose multiple skills. In the second element, we are launching a very comprehensive digital skills platform that will extend the reach of skilling further away from the institution that traditionally gives skilling. So, you

who will work with the local district collector as the district’s public representative in shaping skills according to local requirements. This will be divided into farm economy and non-farm economy... what type of skills are required there, what type of opportunities exist there, and for skills outside the local

Sansthan and apprenticeship training schemes to deliver the skills.



The government has also partnered with Nasscom for FutureSkills Prime.

What is this about?

There is what I call the broad-skilling universe; and then you have the upper end of the skilling